

check_cm_script_docs_sync

check_cm_script_docs_sync.sh

Revision: 1 Last modified: 2026-09-26T14:00:00Z

Overview

Gate CM-SCRIPT-DOCS-SYNC (pre-build invariant 61, BOB-242). Enforces the §11.4.18 script documentation mandate: every shell script under scripts/ has a guide at docs/scripts/<name>.md, and the guide is not older than the script.

Why this exists

The constitution named this gate but nothing implemented it. BOB-223 registered it as gate debt after finding that writing a mandated guide could trip another gate while never writing one cost nothing. This is the implementation.

Prerequisites

bash, git, grep, sort, comm. The argument must be a git repository root.

Usage

```
bash scripts/pre_build/check_cm_script_docs_sync.sh .  
    # gate verdict  
bash scripts/pre_build/check_cm_script_docs_sync.sh . --list  
    # print the current finding set  
CM_SDS_VERBOSE=1 bash scripts/pre_build/  
    check_cm_script_docs_sync.sh .    # list every baselined  
    row
```

What counts as a finding

Key	Meaning
NODOC:<path>	no docs/scripts/<name>.md (name = basename without extension)
DOCBEHIND:<path>	the script changed after its guide

“Changed” is the last commit touching the file. A file with uncommitted edits, or an untracked file, counts as changed now: editing a script without its guide is caught before the commit, and editing both together is not a finding.

Ratchet baseline

scripts/pre_build/cm_script_docs_sync.baseline holds the finding set that existed when the gate landed (seeded 2026-09-26: 52 NODOC + 11 DOCBEHIND = 63 rows). It is compared as a set:

- a finding not in the baseline is **NEW** and fails the gate;
- a baseline row with no matching finding is **RETIRED** and fails the gate — delete the row in the same change that writes or updates the guide;
- rows in both are reported as baselined and do not fail.

The ratchet is the repository’s established default for set-based gates. An operator may instead choose a hard floor or changed-files-only enforcement (§11.4.66); that decision is not made here.

Exit codes

Code	Meaning
0	no NEW finding and no RETIRED row
1	NEW finding(s) and/or RETIRED row(s)
2	harness error: bad arguments, not a git repo, or zero scripts enumerated

Edge cases

- The gate pins `LC_ALL=C`: sort and comm must agree on collation, and under `en_US.UTF-8` they did not (`run_all_challenges` vs `run-tests`), so comm warned and ran on input it considered unsorted.
- Two scripts with the same basename in different directories share one guide.
- A script deleted in the working tree is skipped.
- Scripts outside `scripts/` (for example `tests/`) are out of scope.

Related scripts

- `tests/pre_build/test_check_cm_script_docs_sync.sh` — 12 arms: golden good and bad, ratchet, golden-false, a collation regression, fail-closed, paired mutation.
- `scripts/pre_build/check_cm_doc_revision_header_present.sh` — the \$11.4.44 header check on the same guides.

Last verified

2026-09-26 — real tree after seeding: gate reports no NEW finding from committed state (one NEW finding came from a concurrent stream's uncommitted edit of `scripts/zero_shortcomings_audit.sh`, correctly flagged); test suite 12 passed, 0 failed.